



THE SOUTHERN BELLE'S SECRET

Genre: Southern Gothic Mystery / Family Drama

Format: 90-Minute Movie of the Week

Tone: *The Help* × *Greenleaf* × *A Fall From Grace*

LOGLINE

When a poised Atlanta socialite discovers her family's dark role in a Black teenager's wrongful execution, she must decide whether to protect her dynasty, or tear it down to deliver justice alongside the journalist determined to expose it.

HOOK

In a world of ballrooms, bourbon, and buried secrets, one woman's unraveling becomes the reckoning of an empire.

Southern charm meets generational guilt in this gripping, emotional thriller rooted in legacy, race, and redemption.

MAIN CHARACTERS

Caroline Belle Walker – Elegant, restrained, and emotionally fraying under the weight of appearances. Torn between her inherited privilege and a conscience she can't silence.

Elias Greene – A principled journalist whose mother died trying to prove Samuel Greene's innocence. He returns to Atlanta to finish what she started and finds an unexpected ally in the enemy's daughter.

Eleanor Walker – Caroline's formidable grandmother. Master of manners, mistress of manipulation. She'll preserve the family's image by any means necessary.

SIGNATURE SCENES

- Caroline *throws her pearls into the debutante crowd* and screams the truth after the mic is cut.
 - Eleanor's chilling line: *"We built an empire. What has truth ever been built but ruins?"*
 - Final shot: Caroline at Samuel Greene's grave, placing Elias's mother's locket beside the new plaque: *"EXONERATED."*
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THEMES & TIMELY RELEVANCE

Racial injustice, then and now

The cost of silence among the Southern elite

Justice as both personal and public

Breaking generational cycles of complicity

WHY IT SELLS

- Glamour + high-stakes drama = *Lifetime gold*
 - Tackles race, legacy, and redemption without losing emotional accessibility
 - Southern gothic setting with visual and symbolic flair (pearls, diaries, ballrooms, gravestones)
 - For audiences who love *secrets, scandal, and strong women facing the truth*
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TARGET BUYERS

Lifetime | **BET+** | **OWN** | **Netflix** (Drama) | **Amazon Freevee**

Demographics: Female-skewing, 25–54, socially conscious, Southern-curious